

BROCCOLI

Brassica oleraceam Italica Group

The term “broccoli” is perhaps a little misleading, since it actually encompasses two distinct types of crop: calabrese, which produce the large, fluffy heads commonly referred to as “broccoli”; and sprouting broccoli, which produces an abundance of smaller florets on longer stalks. Sprouting broccoli has a long harvesting season and can be overwintered, making it a valuable winter crop when there is little else on offer.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Give your broccoli a sheltered site in firm, fertile soil, with a pH of at least 6.8. Ensure that you choose a location where other brassicas have not been grown in the last three years. Dig in some well-rotted manure in the fall prior to planting.

Calabrese seed should be sown directly into the ground from mid-spring, successively through to early summer. Sow the seeds at a depth of .75 in (2 cm), and 12 in (30 cm) apart. Plants will grow fairly large so space rows at a distance of 18 in (45 cm).

Sow sprouting broccoli seeds at a depth of .75 in (2 cm) either in trays or modules under cover, or directly in the ground in early spring, covering them until



Harvest to encourage a second crop.

frosts have passed, or in mid-fall, if you want to overwinter them. Sprouting broccoli will grow larger than calabrese, so give them more space—24 in (60 cm) between plants and rows.

CROP CARE

Plants can become quite heavy once heads have developed, so earth up the stems as they